



Smart slime blob

Paris Zoological Park displayed a slime blob that is brainless, but can solve puzzles and make decisions. <https://digit.in/nov19-59>



Toothbrush channels mom

Oral-B has come up with an AI-enabled toothbrush that tells you when you're brushing poorly. <https://digit.in/nov19-60>

EPONYMOUS DISEASES

Doctors who systematically describe diseases often have the dubious honour of permanently attaching their names to the condition. At times, the conditions may also be named after the patients who had them. In very rare cases, diseases are even named after fictional characters. Wikipedia has a list with over 500 diseases named after people. Shown here are some of the well known or notable ones.

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ALZHEIMER'S DISEASE

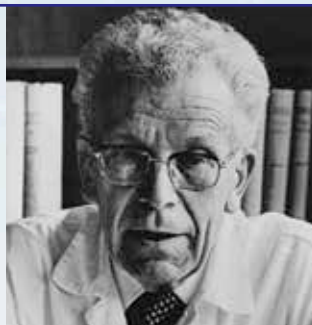
Alois Alzheimer was a German psychiatrist who observed a patient called Auguste Deter over a period of five years, and once she died, opened up her brain.

He found amyloid plaques and neurofibrillary tangles which are signs of Alzheimer's disease. The disease was named by his mentor, Emil Kraepelin, while describing presenile and senile dementia.



ASPERGER SYNDROME

Hans Asperger was an Austrian pediatrician and medical theorist who described what he called "autistic psychopathy" in children. The paper was published during WWII in German. Interestingly, Asperger suffered from the same symptoms in his childhood. The term "Asperger's syndrome" was popularised by the English Psychiatrist, Lorna Wing, in the early 1980s.



DOWN SYNDROME

The disease was described in detail by English physician, John Langdon Down in 1862. In his paper titled "Observations on an Ethnic Classification of Idiots" in 1866, Down described the condition and classified people with Down's syndrome as a "Mongolian Idiot". Although this seems racist, Down used his findings to suggest that races didn't exist.



CROHN'S DISEASE

This inflammatory disease of the digestive system was described by Polish physician, Antoni Leśniowski in 1904. Burrill Bernard Crohn, an American gastroenterologist, described fourteen cases in 1932, along with his colleagues Leon Ginzburg and Gordon Oppenheimer. Because Crohn's name came earlier in the alphabet, the disease became known as Crohn's Disease.



HUNTINGTON'S DISEASE

Although the disease was known since the middle ages, called "chorea", George Huntington thoroughly described the disease in 1872 after studying the medical records of several generations of a single family. He was only 22 when the paper got published. Huntington noted the exact pattern of inheritance, and also that the disease could disappear from a lineage.

